

# Gathering References

Many employers will ask you to provide references at some point in the interview process, so it makes sense to collect them ahead of time. This will also give you a chance to contact your chosen references to make sure that they are willing to talk to prospective employers on your behalf.

Generally speaking, you will need from each reference:

- Name
- Title
- Company
- Mailing address
- Phone number
- Email address

## Example:

*Janice Thompson*

*Development Project Lead*

*Infinite Square Inc.*

*1387 West 14th Street, Suite 4*

*San Mateo, CA 94401*

*650-477-0822 Available between 3:00 to 5:00 PST*

*jthompson@infinitesquare.com*

Do not use references for which you don't have permission. You can also gather references' current contact information and their permission to share it.

Be sure to keep a directory of your references with their contact information somewhere you can easily find it.

## Professional References

Professional references are people who can comment on your past work history. Usually, they should be managers who worked with you and can discuss what you did at past jobs. Note, however, that company policy may prohibit some managers from discussing the details of your work, and they may only be able to verify that you worked at the company and your start and end dates. Check on this policy with them so that you know what you can expect them to share with prospective employers.

Most employers will prefer to talk to your supervisors as professional references, but you can also list:

- Colleagues, if they have worked closely with you
- Professors who are familiar with your classwork if you have a short work history
- People who have supervised or worked with you on a volunteer project

## Personal References

Personal references are people who can talk about your personal character, trustworthiness, honesty, work ethic, and so on. You will rarely need these in modern interviews, but it doesn't hurt to gather some, just in case. They should be people who know you well but are not part of your family. Some examples might be:

- Friends
- Teachers
- Classmates

- Counselors

When choosing these references, be aware that they might reveal personal information about you that may not be appropriate, such as your religious affiliation, if you choose clergy at your church or temple. As with professional references, gather their contact information and permission to be contacted.

## Author(s)

Marty Hale-Evans

Bethany Hudnutt